PLATFORM DOMAIN · DISCOVERY AND VALIDATION

Compare the five system classes, and place this domain among them

Version 2 · 2026-10-19 Prepared by Q. Nkwain Ninying Autonomy level today: R0

This page compares the five classes of AI system and places the platform domain among them. Version 2 reflects the manager's review of version 1. It stays a draft until the manager approves it below.

What changed in version 2

- Placement as an agentic system is confirmed.
- Removed "start with deterministic workflows". The agent is built first and generates its workflows at runtime.
- Added measurement: cost, accuracy and latency decide whether any deterministic pieces are added later.
- Added the platform's existing logging as the deterministic input the agent reads.

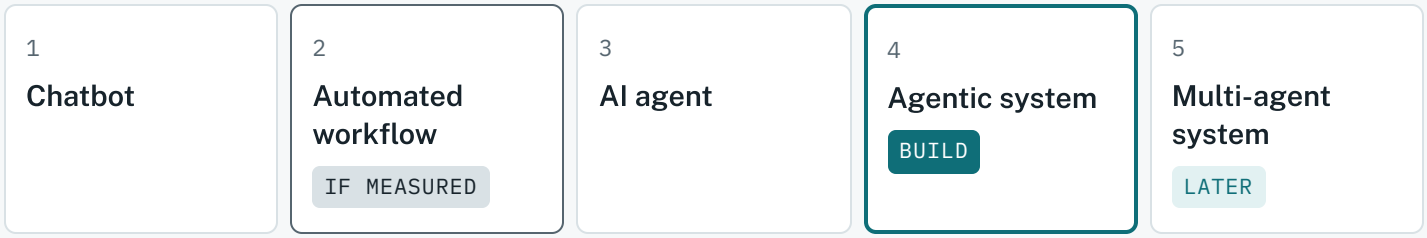
The five system classes

CLASS	WHAT IT DOES	WHO DECIDES THE PATH	WHERE A HUMAN STEPS IN
Chatbot	Answers questions from what it knows or is given	Nobody; it only answers	Always; the human does the work
Automated workflow	Runs predefined steps in a fixed order; an LLM may fill one step	Code	When a step fails or an input is unexpected
AI agent	Uses tools to finish a task and chooses the next tool itself	The model, within the tools it is given	At approval points, or when it is uncertain or blocked

CLASS	WHAT IT DOES	WHO DECIDES THE PATH	WHERE A HUMAN STEPS IN
Agentic system	Plans, acts, checks the result and adjusts until the goal is met or it must stop	The model, looping plan, act, verify	At checkpoints, at hard limits (cost, time, risk), and before anything irreversible
Multi-agent system	Several agents with separate roles hand work to each other	Each agent, coordinating through a shared protocol	At handoffs that cross ownership, and when agents conflict

The key line: in a workflow, code defines the path. In an agent, the model decides it.

Where the platform domain sits



CLASS

Agentic system. Platform reliability work needs something that watches without being asked, triages with evidence, and checks that its own result is right. A chatbot cannot check anything for itself and never notices a problem first.

BUILD

- Build the agent first. Its planner generates each investigation workflow at runtime from the evidence it finds, so no path is hard-coded.
- Measure cost, accuracy and latency once it runs.
- Add deterministic pieces only where the measurements show the agent is inefficient.

INPUT

The platform's existing logging is the deterministic part. The agent reads it where it lives to learn how the system operates, and never copies it.

LATER	One domain agent among several on the platform, handing work to the others. That makes it part of a multi-agent system.
TODAY	**R0, read-only.** The agent changes nothing. Every action needs a human.

Manager review

● APPROVED · VERSION 2

Approved by: K.D.
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